Competitive Audit Report

Food Delivery App User Experience Analysis

Course: CSE 4834 — UI/UX Design Lab
Lab Task: Competitive Audit
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Google Sheet Link:
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1v0Gmx1hEj-nTuHTWG0irp5kQyvkhIQH3FXBU2MuO9u8/edit?usp=sharing

1. Introduction

This competitive audit was conducted as part of the UI/UX Design Lab task. The task required us to analyze existing food delivery platforms and understand how they handle the user journey from discovering restaurants to tracking an order.

A competitive audit helps designers understand what existing products are doing well, where they are weak, and what opportunities exist for a new product. For this audit, we studied several food delivery and related platforms in Bangladesh and compared their features, strengths, weaknesses, and user experience.

2. Goal of the Audit

The main goal of this audit is to compare the user experience of different food ordering platforms.

The audit focuses on:

- Restaurant and food discovery
- Guest browsing option
- Search and filtering
- Promotional offers and discounts
- Payment methods
- Checkout experience
- Delivery instructions
- Real-time order tracking

- Repeat order features

The purpose is to identify useful design ideas for building a better food delivery app.

3. Competitor List

We selected six competitors for this audit. Four are direct competitors and two are indirect competitors. The selected competitors are listed in our prepared spreadsheet.

Competitors	URL of the website	Purpose of the sites
Direct Competitors		
FoodPanda	foodpanda.com.bd	Market-leading on-demand food delivery alongside quick-commerce groceries
Pathao Food	https://food.pathao.com/?_guestTokenRedirected=true	Hyper-local food delivery leveraging an existing, massive pre-established motorbike ridesharing ecosystem.
Foodi	Foodi. com	A prominent domestic food delivery alternative backed by US-Bangla, heavily focusing on local restaurant partnerships.
Munchies	munchies.com.bd	A modern on-demand food delivery app targeted heavily at students and youth with curated fast-food hubs.
Indirect Competitors		
Chaldal	chaldal.com	Online grocery and daily essentials store utilizing dark stores, fulfilling pantry needs rather than hot meals.
Domino's Pizza App	dominos.com.bd	Single-brand proprietary food app managing its own production and delivery pipeline.

FoodPanda, Pathao Food, Foodi, and Munchies are direct competitors because they provide restaurant-based food delivery. Chaldal and Domino's Pizza App are indirect competitors because they are related to food ordering but do not work exactly like a multi-restaurant delivery platform.

4. Feature Comparison Summary

The competitors were compared using important UX features such as guest browsing, tracking, category browsing, payment support, promotions, filtering, and delivery instructions.

Feature	FoodPanda	PathaoFood	Foodi	Munchies	Chaldal	Domino's Pizza
Guest Browsing Option	Yes (Can view menus instantly without logging in).	No (Blocks user with an immediate mobile OTP phone wall).	Yes (Allows users to explore nearby restaurants and menus without an account).	Yes (Frictionless entry to browse targeted food bundles).	Yes (Full inventory viewable without account).	Yes (Can see deals and menu directly).
Real-time Order Map Tracking	Yes (Live interactive GPS tracker for the rider map).	Yes (Highly accurate map tracking leveraging ride fleet).	Yes (Features interactive live map tracking showing rider distance).	Yes (Standard map integration showing rider progression markers).	No (Milestone tracking only: "Dispatched", "Near You").	Yes (Proprietary "Pizza Tracker" interface).
Cuisine-Specific Categorization	High (Granular tags for Categories, Spices, Healthy, etc.)	Good (Categorized by basic popular food items and distance).	Strong (Focuses heavily on local Bangladeshi favorites like Biryani, Fast Food, and Desserts with clear visual icons).	Highly Targeted (Streamlined categories optimized around popular late-night snacks, burgers, and platters).	N/A (Categorized by household grocery departments).	None (Strictly structured around proprietary pizza and sides).
Promotional & Discount Visibility	High (Aggressive banners, pop-ups, and auto-applied vouchers).	Moderate (Deals are tucked inside restaurant cards or a dedicated tab).	High (Offers distinct "Foodi Offers" sections and prominent free delivery tags on the home screen).	Very High (Promotions integrated into the main feed via trendy social-style UI banners).	High (Focuses on bundle deals, discounts on bulk, and cashbacks).	High (Entirely built around combo deals and coupon codes).
Payment Ecosystem Support	Cash on Delivery, bKash, Credit/Debit cards.	Cash on Delivery, Pathao Pay, bKash.	Supports Cash on Delivery, bKash, Nagad, Rocket, Visa/Mastercard	Cash on Delivery, bKash, and various local digital wallets.	Cash, bKash, Nagad, Visa/Mastercard.	Cash on Delivery, digital cards, or bKash at delivery doorstep.
Past Order Quick Re-ordering	Yes (Features a prominent "Order Again" shortcut button on the main dashboard tab).	Yes (Accessible via user profile transaction history).	Partial (Hidden deep within past order logs; requires manual taps).	No (Relies primarily on dynamic, algorithmic home-feed discovery).	Yes(Highly optimized "Buy Again" predictive layout based on consumption cycles).	Yes (Features a dedicated "Easy Order" saving option for favorite meals).
Multi-Filter Sorting System	Advanced (Filters concurrently by delivery fee, rating, promotional vouchers, price etc).	Moderate (Primarily filters by active promotions and basic distance constraints).	Basic (Standard sorting by high-to-low ratings or delivery times).	Minimal (Relies on a streamlined, scrollable landing feed with few sorting tags).	Advanced (Deep sorting by brand, price brackets, pack size, and unit weights).	Minimal (Filters strictly isolate coupons, deals, or vegetarian/non-vegetarian variations).
Special Delivery Micro-Instructions	Yes (Dedicated visual UI fields for "Leave at door", "Don't ring bell", or drop-off pin notes).	Yes (Standard text input window bound directly into the final order landing screen).	Basic (Standard single-row text window for short address directions).	Basic (Simple instruction field focused mostly on phone contact rules).	Partial (Highly optimized for "Contactless Delivery" checkboxes, but sparse text fields).	Yes (Detailed schedule select drop-downs and delivery timing windows).

From the comparison, FoodPanda appears to be the most feature-rich platform. Pathao Food is strong in delivery tracking. Foodi is strong in local food categories. Munchies has a trendy and

youth-friendly interface. Chaldal is strong in repeat purchasing and grocery filtering. Domino's has a simple and focused ordering flow.

5. Competitor Analysis

Strengths/Weakness	FoodPanda	PathaoFood	Foodi	Munchies	Chaldal	Domino's Pizza
Strengths	Seamless, low-barrier onboarding with frictionless guest browsing.	Excellent real-time tracking accuracy and fast delivery times by directly utilizing Pathao's massive pre-existing motorcycle courier infrastructure.	The visual layout and category chips are heavily optimized for local Bangladeshi culinary preferences (e.g., highly visible shortcuts for Kacchi, Khichuri, and street food)	Highly trendy, modern visual layout	Industry-leading checkout simplicity; predictive search engine handles mixed spelling mistakes and localized names perfectly	Highly gamified milestone tracking UI ("Pizza Tracker") that keeps users engaged
	Highly responsive predictive search bar.	Utilizes the unified "Pathao Pay" internal wallet	Clean user interface that isolates food delivery cleanly and keeps separated	Excellent micro-interactions and animations that make browsing food feel gamified and engaging.	Seamless item repetition matching via historical tracking.	Strict adherence to the "30 minutes or free" delivery countdown clock integrated right into the interface.
	Uses bright, highly contrasting pink UI accent markers for promotional discounts, free delivery tags, and active voucher banners		Integrates deep native support for a wide variety of domestic mobile financial services	Allows users to mix and match disparate food choices (e.g., combining specialized desserts and savory burgers) into a single cart checkout		Keeps the checkout funnel intensely focused on high-margin single-tap coupon add-ons, bundle builders, and combo upgrades.
				Shows limited-time discount codes directly in the main food listing cards without interrupting the user experience		
Weakness	Cluttered UI due to the forced aggregation of groceries and restaurants on one landing view	High initial user drop-off rate because it completely locks out users behind an OTP verification wall before allowing them to see menus	Active rider availability and restaurant pools can be considerably sparse outside of major Dhaka zones compared to the market giants	Niche restaurant catalog compared to massive platforms like FoodPanda;	The layout and asset imagery are optimized for grocery items, failing to visually prompt instant hunger cravings for meals.	Highly restrictive single-brand layout; does not allow multi-cuisine exploration, which limits its use for group orders with varying tastes.
	Finding a pathway to a human support agent is buried behind multiple layers of automated AI chatbot decision trees.	Lacks multi-criteria granular sorting; search relies heavily on raw distance maps or highly generic cuisine categories.	The map tracking marker can jump or lag during weak data signals.	Operational zone boundaries are strictly limited to dense metropolitan food hubs.	Completely lacks a live interactive map layout, which can raise user delivery anxietyUses static, unmoving text milestone notifications, which fails to accurately manage arrival expectations for users waiting for hot, time-sensitive food.	Does not offer automated profile voucher scanning; users must manually input string codes or intentionally seek out active deals.
	Auto-selects a delivery rider tip late in the transaction funnel, displaying them only at the final confirmation step rather than inside the cart.	The monolithic architecture of the multi-app runs noticeably slow or lags a lot	The feature to repeat a past purchase is buried deep within multi-layer transaction tabs, increasing task time.			

6. Key Findings

From the audit, several common UX patterns were found:

1. **Guest browsing is important**
   Users prefer to explore menus and prices before logging in.
2. **Live tracking builds trust**
   Real-time order tracking helps users feel more confident after placing an order.
3. **Promotions influence ordering decisions**
   Discounts, vouchers, free delivery, and combo offers are highly visible in most apps.
4. **Local payment options are necessary**
   Cash on delivery, bKash, Nagad, Rocket, and cards are important for Bangladeshi users.
5. **Repeat ordering improves convenience**
   Features like "Order Again," "Buy Again," and saved favorite meals save time for returning users.
6. **Too much content can make the UI confusing**
   Apps like FoodPanda offer many features, but the interface can feel crowded.

7. Design Recommendations

Based on the audit, a new food delivery app should include the following design improvements:

- Allow users to browse without logging in first.
- Keep the homepage clean and organized.
- Use local food categories like biryani, kacchi, khichuri, fast food, desserts, and snacks.
- Provide strong search and filtering options.

- Show discounts clearly but avoid too many pop-ups.
- Support cash on delivery, bKash, Nagad, Rocket, and cards.
- Show delivery fee, service charge, and total cost clearly before checkout.
- Include live rider tracking or clear milestone tracking.
- Add an easy “Order Again” or “Favorite Meal” feature.
- Make customer support easy to access.

8. Conclusion

This competitive audit helped us understand how existing food delivery and related platforms support the food ordering journey. FoodPanda is strong in features, Pathao Food is strong in delivery tracking, Foodi is strong in local food categories, Munchies is strong in modern visual design, Chaldal is strong in repeat purchasing, and Domino’s Pizza App is strong in focused checkout and gamified tracking.

However, these platforms also have weaknesses such as cluttered interfaces, forced login, limited filtering, limited restaurant coverage, and lack of live tracking in some cases.

For a new food delivery app, the best design approach would be to combine the strongest features from these competitors: guest browsing, clean layout, local food categories, strong search, visible offers, simple checkout, flexible payment, repeat ordering, and reliable tracking. This would create a smoother and more user-friendly food delivery experience.